Unit 4 Guided Notes — Geometry: Angles & Triangles

ANSWER KEY

Name the angle pair. Write an equation. Solve for x.

🎯 By the end of this unit, I can…

- Use angle relationships formed by parallel lines and a transversal
- Apply the Triangle Angle-Sum and Exterior-Angle Theorems
- Solve for unknown angles by writing and solving equations

Standard: NC.8.G.5

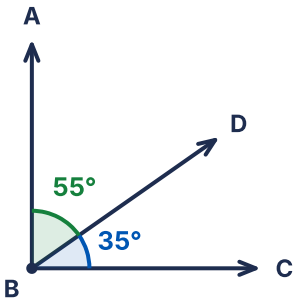
Answer key: every blank and final answer is filled in green.

1 Angle Relationships

Relationship	Definition	Sum / Rule
Complementary	Two angles that add to **90** °	**a + b = 90°**
Supplementary	Two angles that add to **180** °	**a + b = 180°**
Vertical Angles	**Opposite angles when two lines cross**	**Always EQUAL**
Linear Pair	**Adjacent angles on a straight line**	**Add to 180°**

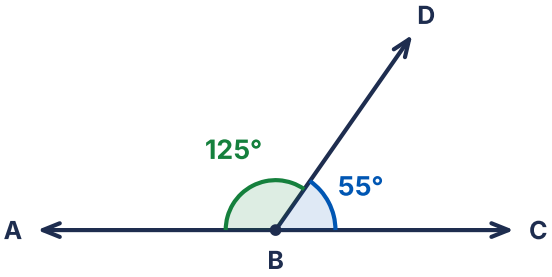
Each angle is named with three letters — the vertex is the MIDDLE letter (e.g. ∠ABD has vertex B). Arcs show which angle each measure belongs to.

COMPLEMENTARY = 90°



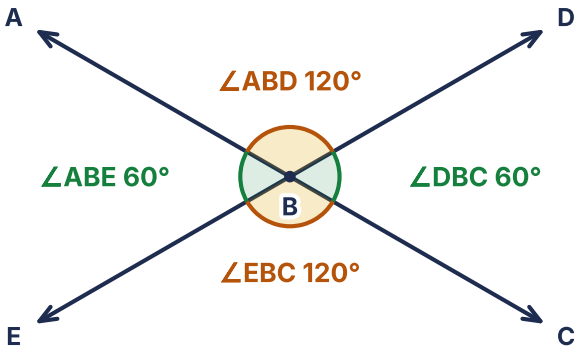
35° + 55° = 90°

SUPPLEMENTARY = 180°



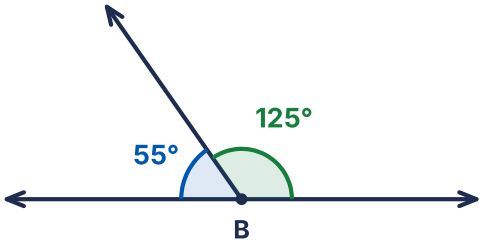
55° + 125° = 180°

VERTICAL ANGLES



Opposite angles are EQUAL: ∠ABD = ∠EBC, ∠DBC = ∠ABE

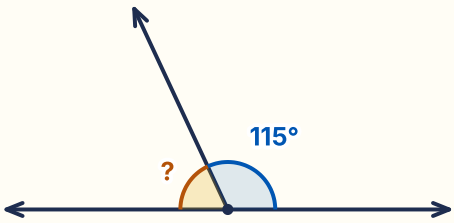
LINEAR PAIR = 180°



side by side on a line: 125° + 55° = 180°

Quick Check

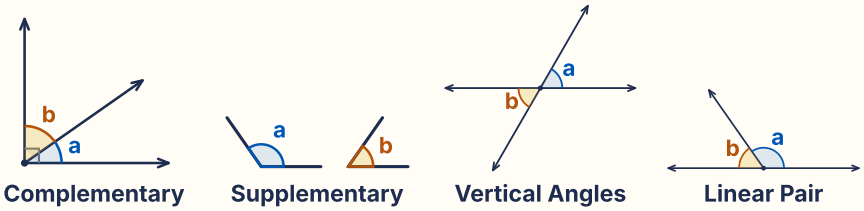
MC Two angles form a linear pair. One measures 115°. What is the other?



- ● **65°**
- ○ 75°
- ○ 245°

Match the Relationship to its Rule

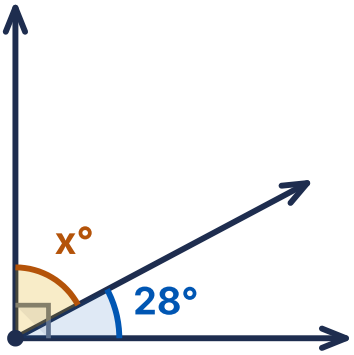
MATCH Write the letter of the matching rule on each line.



B	1. Complementary	**A.** Always EQUAL
D	2. Supplementary	**B.** Add to 90°
A	3. Vertical Angles	**C.** Adjacent angles on a line → 180°
C	4. Linear Pair	**D.** Add to 180°

✏ Practice: Angle Relationships

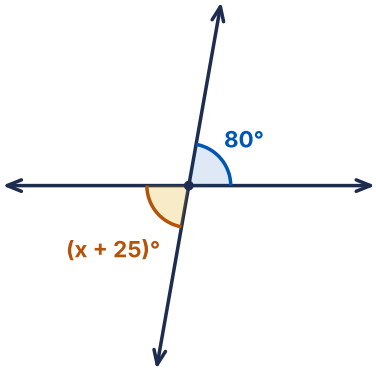
1. Score 3 The two angles are complementary. Find x.



Answer: 62

How to do it: Complementary angles add to 90°. x + 28 = 90, so x = 90 − 28 = 62.

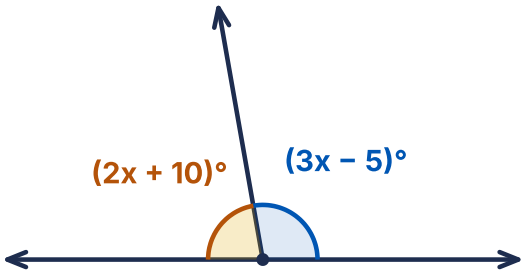
2. Score 4 Two lines cross. Find x.



Answer: 55

How to do it: The angles are across from each other, so they are vertical angles. Vertical angles are equal: x + 25 = 80. Subtract 25 from both sides: x = 55.

3. Score 5 The two angles form a linear pair. Find x.



Answer: 35

How to do it: A linear pair adds to 180°. (3x − 5) + (2x + 10) = 180. Combine like terms: 5x + 5 = 180. Subtract 5: 5x = 175. Divide by 5: x = 35. Check: 3(35) − 5 = 100° and 2(35) + 10 = 80°, and 100° + 80° = 180° ✓

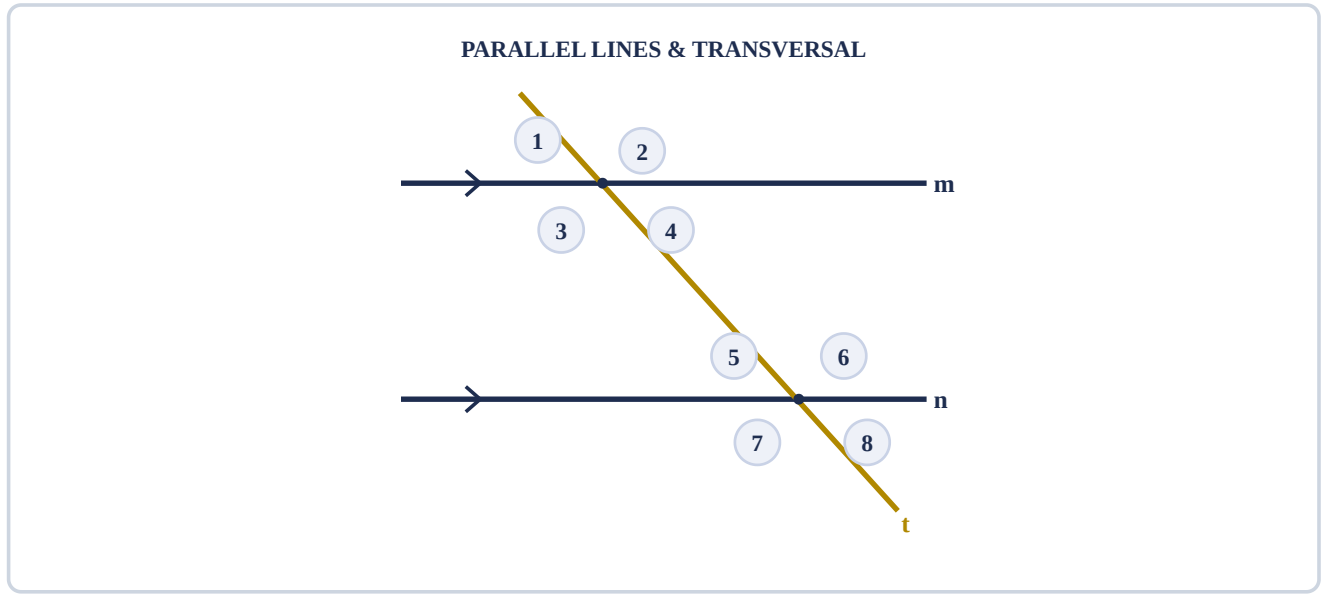
2 Parallel Lines & Transversals

📖 **Words to know**

Parallel lines: lines that never meet.

Transversal: a line that crosses two or more lines.

📌 **REMEMBER:** Corresponding, Alternate Interior, Alternate Exterior, and Vertical angles are CONGRUENT (equal). Same-Side Interior and Same-Side Exterior angles are SUPPLEMENTARY (add to 180°).

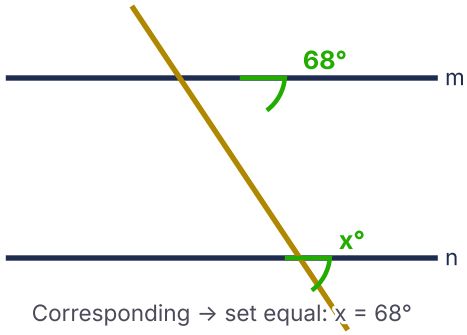


Two parallel lines (m ∥ n) cut by transversal t form 8 angles.

- Corresponding: (1, 5), (2, 6), (3, 7), (4, 8)
- Alternate Interior: (3, 6), (4, 5)
- Alternate Exterior: (1, 8), (2, 7)
- Same-Side Interior: (3, 5), (4, 6)

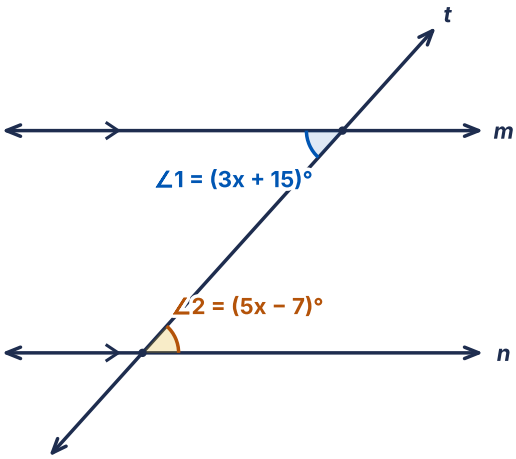
Angle Pair Type	Relationship	Rule to Use	Example
Corresponding	Congruent	Set equal	68° → x = 68°
Alternate Interior	Congruent	Set equal	101° → x = 101°
Alternate Exterior	Congruent	Set equal	142° → x = 142°
Vertical	Congruent	Set equal	120° → x = 120°
Same-Side Interior	Supplementary	180 − given	134° → x = 46°
Same-Side Exterior	Supplementary	180 − given	77° → x = 103°

CORRESPONDING ANGLES ARE EQUAL



Corresponding → set equal: x = 68°

Worked Example — ∠1 = 3x + 15 and ∠2 = 5x − 7 (alternate interior angles)



∠1 and ∠2: between the lines, opposite sides of t

Alternate interior angles are EQUAL: $3x + 15 = 5x - 7$

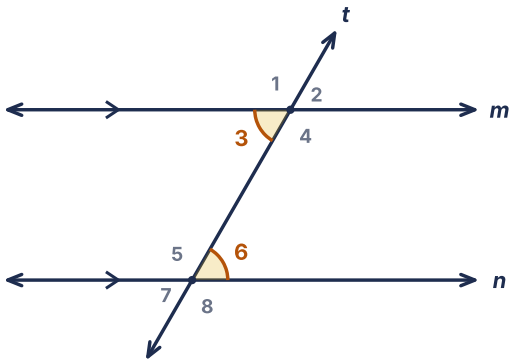
Subtract 3x: $15 = 2x - 7$

Add 7: $22 = 2x$

✓ **Divide by 2:** $x = 11$ → angle = $3(11) + 15 = 48°$

✏ Practice: Parallel Lines & Transversals

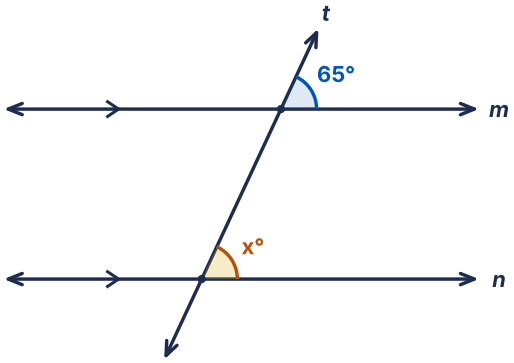
1. Score 3 Lines m and n are parallel. What kind of angle pair are ∠3 and ∠6?



- ○ Corresponding
- ● **Alternate interior**
- ○ Same-side interior

> **How to do it:** ∠3 and ∠6 are both between the parallel lines (interior). They are on opposite sides of t (alternate). So they are alternate interior angles, and they are equal.

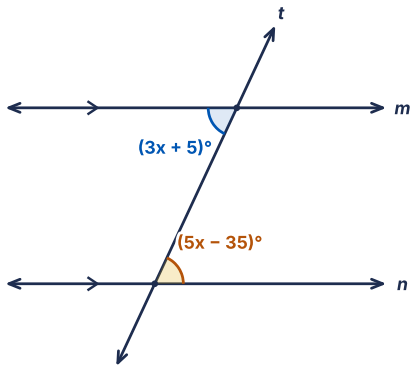
2. Score 3 Lines m and n are parallel. Find x.



Answer: 65

> **How to do it:** The 65° angle and x are in the same corner at each crossing, so they are corresponding angles. Corresponding angles are equal: x = 65.

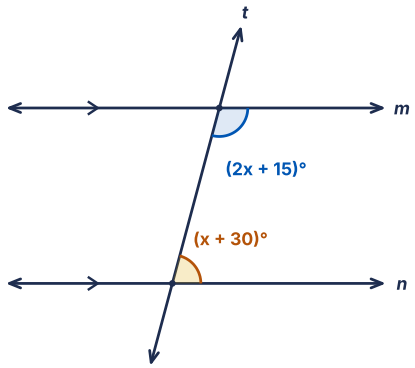
3. Score 4 Lines m and n are parallel. Find x.



Answer: 20

How to do it: Alternate interior angles are equal: 3x + 5 = 5x − 35. Subtract 3x: 5 = 2x − 35. Add 35: 40 = 2x. Divide by 2: x = 20. Check: 3(20) + 5 = 65° and 5(20) − 35 = 65° ✓

4. Score 5 Lines m and n are parallel. Find x. Then find the measure of the angle marked (2x + 15)°.



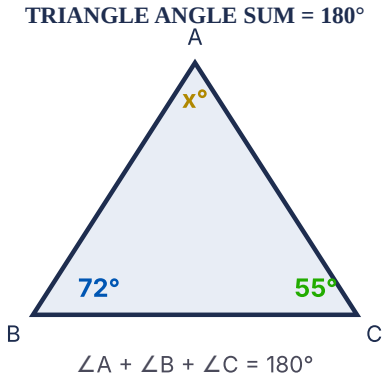
Answer: 105

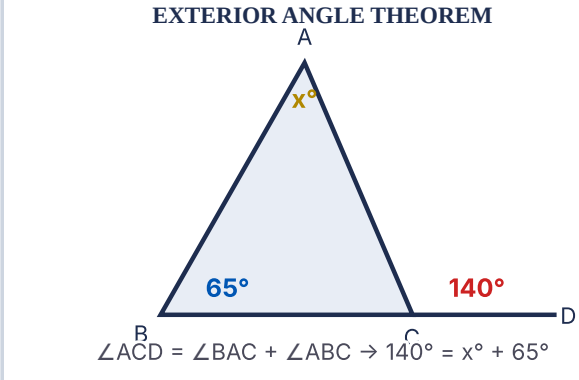
How to do it: Both angles are between the lines on the same side of t, so they are same-side interior angles. They add to 180°: (2x + 15) + (x + 30) = 180 → 3x + 45 = 180 → 3x = 135 → x = 45. The angle is 2(45) + 15 = 105°. Check: the other angle is 45 + 30 = 75°, and 105° + 75° = 180° ✓

3 Triangle Theorems

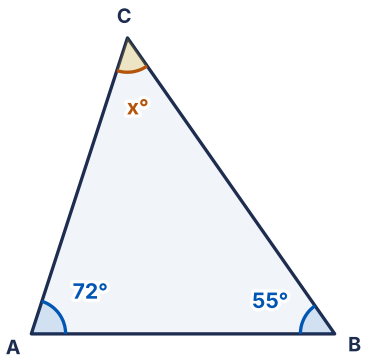
🔑 **TRIANGLE ANGLE SUM:** The three interior angles of a triangle always add up to 180°.

🔑 **EXTERIOR ANGLE THEOREM:** An exterior angle equals the two far inside angles added together. These are the **remote interior angles**.



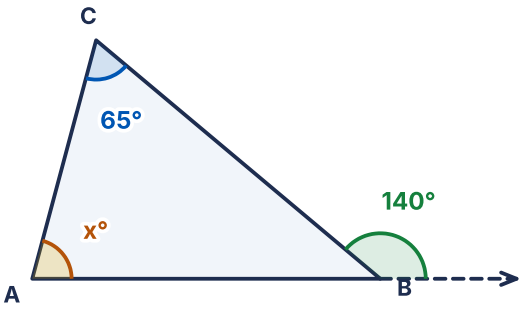


Problem 1 — Triangle Angle Sum: x + 72 + 55 = 180



Solve: x + 127 = 180 → x = 53°

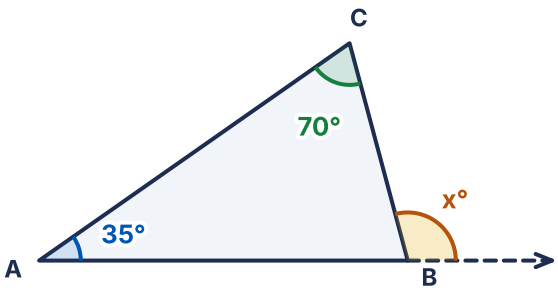
Problem 2 — Exterior Angle Theorem: x + 65 = 140



the outside angle = the two far inside angles

Solve: x + 65 = 140 → x = 75°

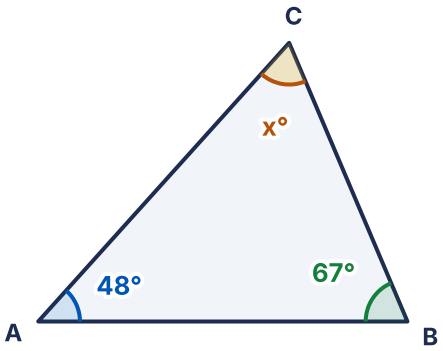
ERROR ANALYSIS Jordan's Exterior Angle Mistake — A triangle has interior angles 35° and 70°. Exterior angle = x. Jordan wrote `x = 70 − 35 = 35°`.



Jordan subtracted instead of adding. The exterior angle = SUM of the remote interior angles: x = 35 + 70 = 105°.

✏ Practice: Triangle Theorems

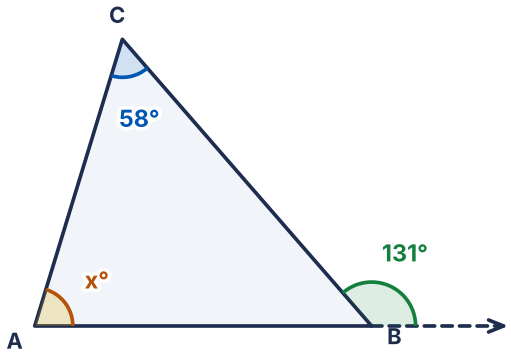
1. Score 3 Find x.



Answer: 65

How to do it: The angles of a triangle add to 180°. x + 48 + 67 = 180 → x + 115 = 180 → x = 65.

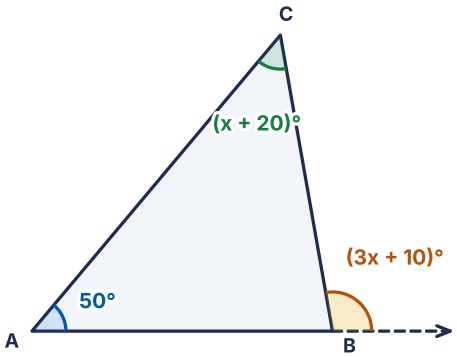
2. Score 4 The exterior (outside) angle is 131°. Find x.



Answer: 73

How to do it: Exterior Angle Theorem: the outside angle = the sum of the two far (remote) inside angles. x + 58 = 131. Subtract 58: x = 73.

3. Score 5 Find x. Then find the measure of the exterior angle, (3x + 10)°.



Answer: 100

How to do it: Exterior angle = sum of the two far inside angles: 3x + 10 = 50 + (x + 20). Simplify: 3x + 10 = x + 70. Subtract x: 2x + 10 = 70. Subtract 10: 2x = 60, so x = 30. Exterior angle = 3(30) + 10 = 100°. Check: 50 + (30 + 20) = 100 ✓

4 Angle-Angle (AA) Similarity

📖 **Words to know**

Similar: same shape, maybe a different size.

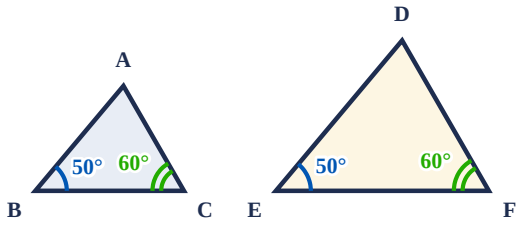
Scale factor: the number you multiply each side by to get the matching side.

In proportion: every side is multiplied by the same scale factor.

🔑 **SIMILAR TRIANGLES:** Two triangles are *similar* (written △ABC ~ △DEF) when they have the same shape but not necessarily the same size. Corresponding angles are equal and corresponding sides are in proportion.

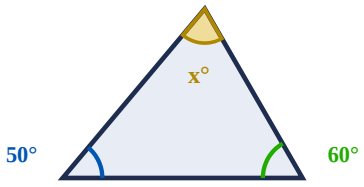
🔑 **ANGLE-ANGLE (AA) CRITERION:** If two angles of one triangle are equal to two angles of another triangle, then the triangles are similar. You only ever need to check TWO pairs of angles.

ANGLE-ANGLE (AA) CRITERION



matching marks = equal angles → △ABC ~ △DEF

WHY TWO ANGLES ARE ENOUGH

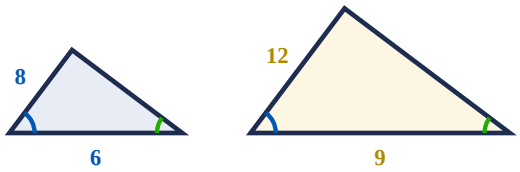


50° + 60° + x° = 180° → x = 70°

the third angle is forced, so all three match

🔑 **WHY TWO ANGLES ARE ENOUGH:** The angles of a triangle add to 180°. If two pairs match, the third pair must match too.

SIMILAR → SIDES IN PROPORTION

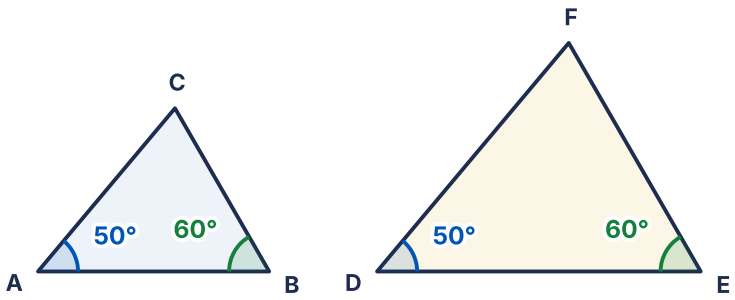


9 ÷ 6 = 1.5 and 12 ÷ 8 = 1.5

scale factor 1.5

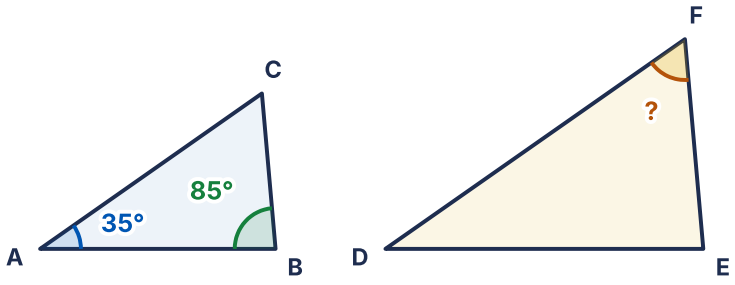
📌 **WATCH OUT:** AA needs two pairs of angles that *match each other* — not simply two angles given in each triangle.

Problem 1 — Are they similar? ∠A = 50°, ∠B = 60° and ∠D = 50°, ∠E = 60°



Decide: Two pairs of angles are equal (50° = 50° and 60° = 60°), so by AA the triangles are similar: △ABC ~ △DEF.

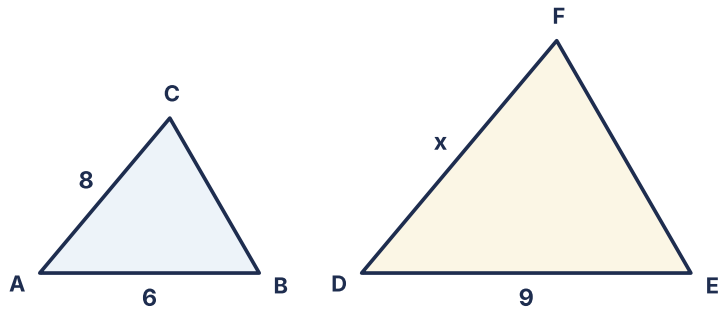
Problem 2 — △ABC ~ △DEF with ∠A = 35° and ∠B = 85°. Find ∠F.



F matches C

Solve: ∠C = 180 − 35 − 85 = 60°. ∠F corresponds to ∠C, so ∠F = 60°.

Problem 3 — Similar triangles: sides 6 and 8 match sides 9 and x. Find x.



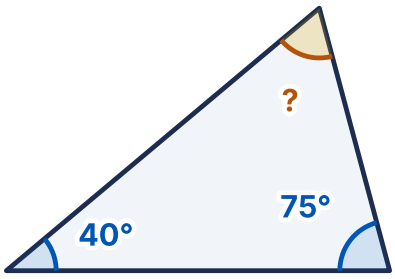
6 → 9 and 8 → x

Solve: Scale factor = 9 ÷ 6 = 1.5, so x = 8 × 1.5 = 12.

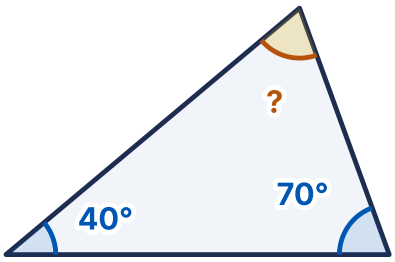
ERROR ANALYSIS Riley's AA Mistake — Triangle 1 has angles 40° and 75°. Triangle 2 has angles 40° and 70°. Riley wrote

"Each triangle shows two angles, so they are similar by AA."

Triangle 1



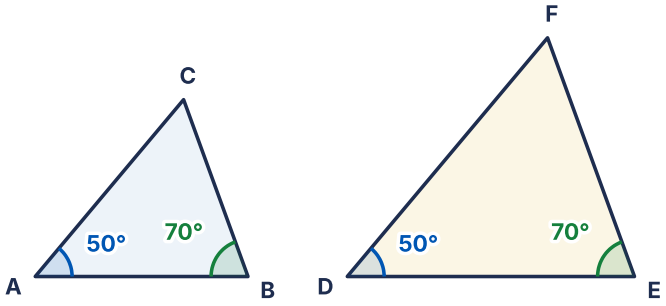
Triangle 2



AA needs two pairs of angles that match *each other*. Only the 40° angles match here. Triangle 1's angles are 40°, 75°, 65°; Triangle 2's are 40°, 70°, 70°. The two sets are different, so the triangles are **not** similar.

✏ Practice: AA Similarity

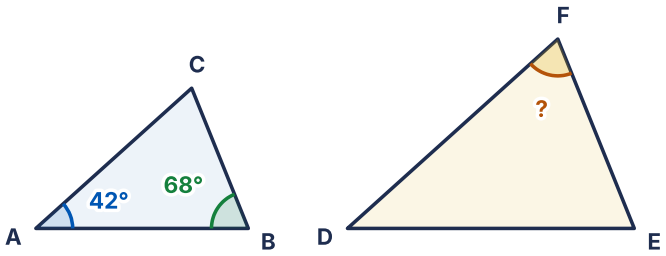
1. Score 3 Are these two triangles similar?



- ● **Yes — two pairs of angles match**
- ○ No — they are different sizes
- ○ You can't tell

> **How to do it:** ∠A = ∠D = 50° and ∠B = ∠E = 70°. Two pairs of angles match, so the triangles are similar by AA. Size does not matter.

2. Score 4 △ABC ~ △DEF. Find the measure of ∠F.

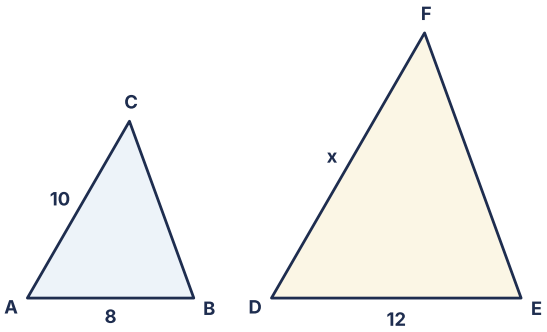


F matches C

Answer: 70

> **How to do it:** ∠C = 180 − 42 − 68 = 70°. ∠F corresponds to ∠C, so ∠F = 70°.

3. Score 4 The triangles are similar. Side 8 matches side 12, and side 10 matches side x. Find x.



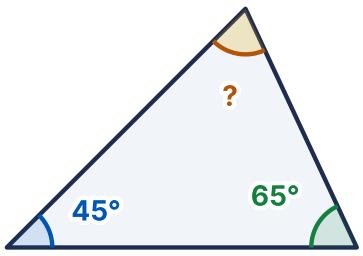
8 → 12 and 10 → x

Answer: 15

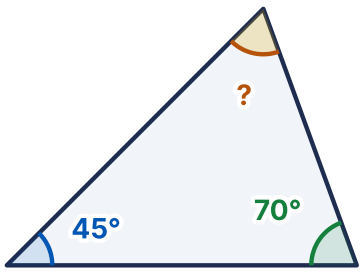
How to do it: Scale factor = 12 ÷ 8 = 1.5. So x = 10 × 1.5 = 15.

4. Score 5 Triangle 1 shows 45° and 65°. Triangle 2 shows 45° and 70°. Sam says they are NOT similar. Is Sam right?

Triangle 1



Triangle 2



○ Yes — they are not similar

● **No — they are similar**

How to do it: Triangle 1: third angle = 180 − 45 − 65 = 70°, so its angles are 45°, 65°, 70°. Triangle 2: third angle = 180 − 45 − 70 = 65°, so its angles are 45°, 70°, 65°. Both have 45°, 65° and 70°. Two pairs match, so they ARE similar by AA. Sam is not right.

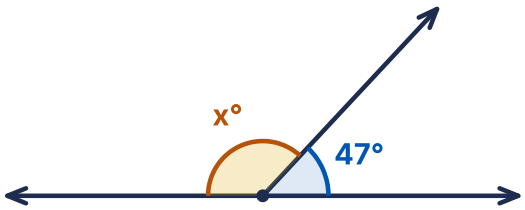
✏ Part 2 — Practice, Score 3

📌 **Show every step on its own line.** Box your final answer.

Every problem has a level: Score 3 Score 4 Score 5. Start with Score 3, then move up.

Score 3 Start here

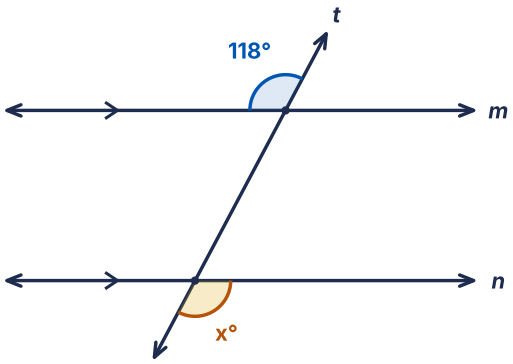
1. Score 3 The two angles are supplementary. Find x.



Answer: 133

How to do it: Supplementary angles add to 180°. x + 47 = 180, so x = 180 − 47 = 133.

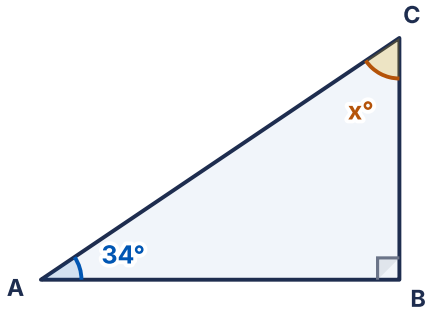
2. Score 3 Lines m and n are parallel. Find x.



Answer: 118

How to do it: The angles are outside the parallel lines and on opposite sides of t, so they are alternate exterior angles. They are equal: x = 118.

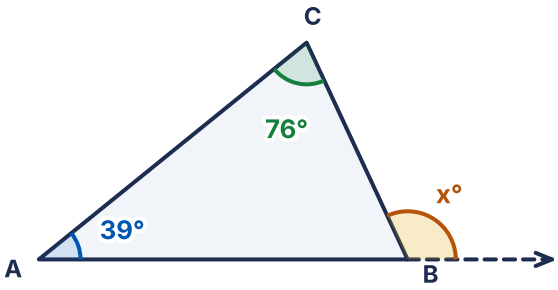
3. Score 3 Find x. (The square corner is a right angle.)



Answer: 56

How to do it: A right angle is 90°. x + 34 + 90 = 180 → x + 124 = 180 → x = 56.

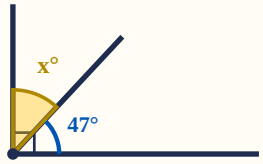
4. Score 3 Find the exterior angle x.



Answer: 115

How to do it: Exterior Angle Theorem: x = 39 + 76 = 115.

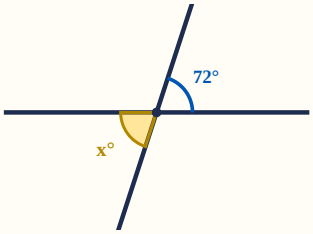
Score 3 **5) Complementary Angles, given 47°. x = ?**



x = 43°

How to do it: Complementary angles add to 90°: x = 90 − 47 = 43.

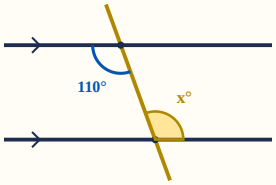
Score 3 **6) Vertical Angles, given 72°. x = ?**



x = 72°

How to do it: Vertical angles are equal: x = 72.

Score 3 **7) Alternate Interior, given 110°. x = ?**



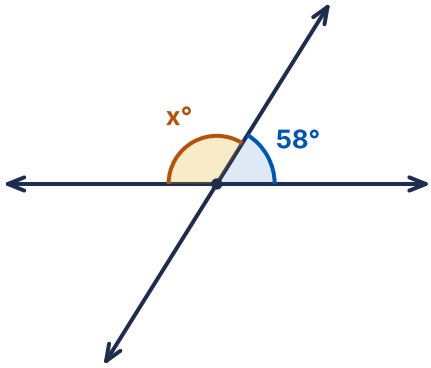
x = 110°

How to do it: Alternate Interior angles are equal: x = 110.

Part 2 — Practice, Score 4

Score 4 **On grade level**

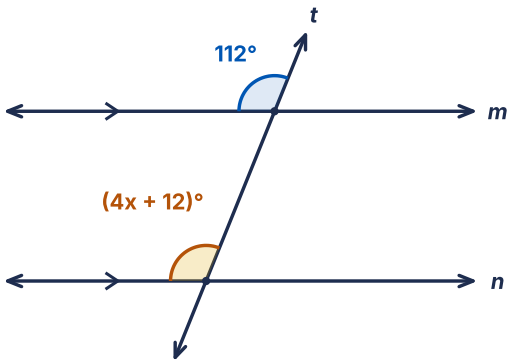
1. Score 4 Two lines cross. Find x.



Answer: 122

How to do it: x and 58° sit side by side on a straight line, so they are a linear pair. x + 58 = 180, so x = 122. (They are not vertical angles — vertical angles are across from each other.)

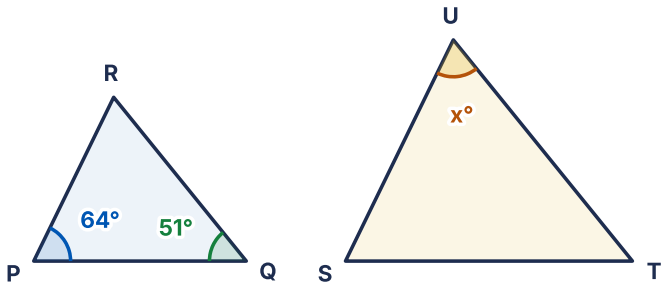
2. Score 4 Lines m and n are parallel. Find x.



Answer: 25

How to do it: The angles are in the same corner at each crossing, so they are corresponding angles and are equal. 4x + 12 = 112. Subtract 12: 4x = 100. Divide by 4: x = 25.

3. Score 4 △PQR ~ △STU. Find x.

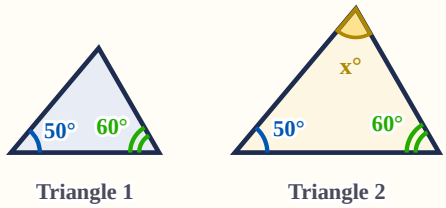


U matches R

Answer: 65

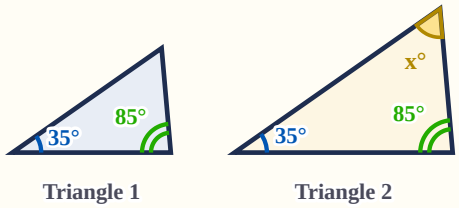
How to do it: ∠R = 180 − 64 − 51 = 65°. ∠U corresponds to ∠R, so x = 65.

Score 4 **4) AA Similarity — two angles match: 50° and 60°. x = ?**



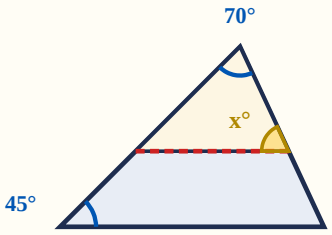
How to do it: Two angles match (50° and 60°), so the triangles are similar by AA. The third angle: x = 180 − 50 − 60 = 70.

Score 4 **5) △ABC ~ △DEF, given 35° and 85°. x = ?**



How to do it: ∠C = 180 − 35 − 85 = 60°. ∠F corresponds to ∠C, so x = 60.

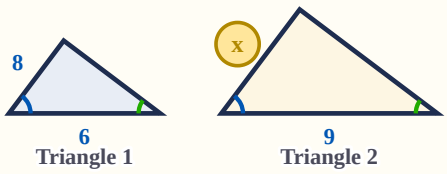
Score 4 **6) Parallel line inside a triangle, given 70° and 45°. x = ?**



the dashed line is parallel to the base

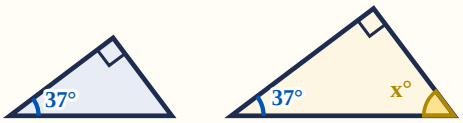
How to do it: The dashed line is parallel to the base, so the small top triangle has the same angles as the big one (corresponding angles). Its three angles add to 180°: x = 180 − 70 − 45 = 65.

Score 4 **7) Similar triangles — sides 6 and 8 match 9 and x. x = ?**



How to do it: Scale factor = 9 ÷ 6 = 1.5. x = 8 × 1.5 = 12.

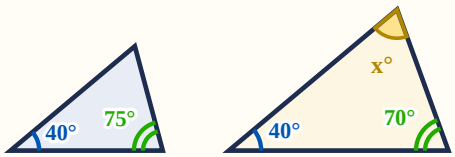
Score 4 **8) Similar right triangles, given 37°. x = ?**



Triangle 1 Triangle 2

How to do it: Both triangles have a 90° angle and a 37° angle, so they are similar by AA. x = 180 − 90 − 37 = 53.

Score 4 **9) Triangle 1: 40°, 75°. Triangle 2: 40°, 70°. Find x, Triangle 2's third angle.**



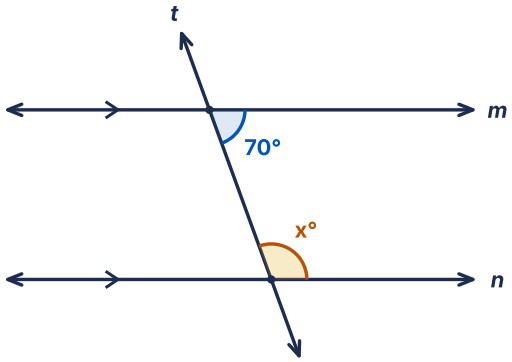
Triangle 1 Triangle 2

How to do it: Triangle 2's angles add to 180°: x = 180 − 40 − 70 = 70. (Triangle 1's third angle is 180 − 40 − 75 = 65°, so the triangles are NOT similar.)

Part 2 — Practice, Score 5

Score 5 **Challenge**

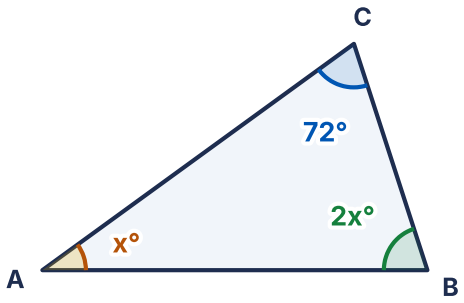
1. Score 5 Lines m and n are parallel. Maya says x = 70 because the angles "look the same." Find the correct value of x.



Answer: 110

How to do it: The angles are between the lines and on the same side of t, so they are same-side interior angles. Those add to 180°, they are not equal. x + 70 = 180, so x = 110. Maya's mistake: she set them equal.

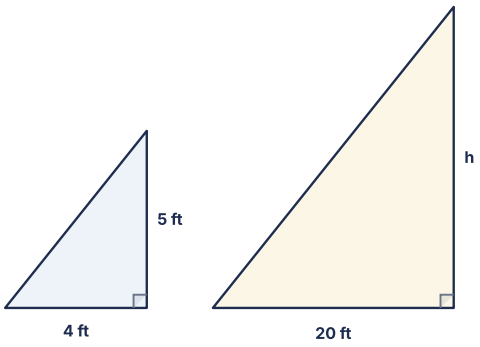
2. Score 5 Find x.



Answer: 36

How to do it: The angles add to 180°: x + 2x + 72 = 180. Combine like terms: 3x + 72 = 180. Subtract 72: 3x = 108. Divide by 3: x = 36. Check: 36 + 72 + 72 = 180 ✓

3. Score 5 A 5 ft student casts a 4 ft shadow. At the same time, a tree casts a 20 ft shadow. The two triangles are similar (AA). How tall is the tree?



student and shadow → tree and shadow (not to scale)

Answer: 25

How to do it: The sun hits both at the same angle, and both stand straight up (90°), so the triangles are similar by AA. Scale factor = 20 ÷ 4 = 5. Tree height h = 5 × 5 = 25 ft.